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Coinbase

Poor Crypto Environment Weighs on 4Q25, But Mgmt. Demonstrates Its Conviction by Increasing Its Investment in Crypto and Buying Back Its Stock

Overweight

COIN, COIN US
Price (12 Feb 26):$141.09
▼**Price Target (Dec-26):$252.00**
Prior (Dec-26):$290.00

Coinbase reported GAAP EPS of ($2.49) versus Investor Relations' aggregated consensus of ($0.05). Adj. EPS totaled $0.66 when excluding the crypto investment portfolio's gains and losses and mark-to-market of strategic investments. Adj. EBITDA of $566mn came in lighter than expected by consensus' $655mn. As expected, a weak crypto pricing and activity environment in 4Q25 weighed on results, but we saw Coinbase's philosophy to invest through the cycle with elevated operating expenses (+22% YoY) dragging results even further. We maintain our Overweight rating, but our price target falls to $252 after accounting for lower token volume and market cap estimates and a lower Circle market cap.

- **A miss on both transaction revenue and take rate.** 4Q25 transaction revenue totaled $983mn, slightly below the consensus of $1,002mn, per Coinbase's published consensus. Here, we observed both trading volumes and the net take rate decline sequentially. Spot trading volumes totaled $271bn (consensus $274bn) and the retail take rate declined sequentially to 131bps (JPMe 145bps) vs. 143bps reported last quarter. Mgmt attributed the softer take rate to a mix shift towards Advanced trading (lower fee vs. Simple trading) and a greater percentage of volume under the Coinbase One no-trading fees threshold, thus pressuring trading fees. We adjust our approach to modeling these take rates and lower them going forward (125-135bps vs. ~140bps previously) given our view that Coinbase One user count (~971k at 2025 year end, +32% YoY) will continue to grow, especially if it becomes the only vehicle through which Coinbase can share USDC reserve income under new market structure legislation.
- **CEO more positive on market structure legislation.** Conversations around quarterly results have been keenly focused on the development of U.S. crypto market structure legislation, particularly in the Senate Banking Committee where debate around stablecoin interest payments lingers and threatens the passage of the bill. CEO Brian Armstrong said he was "quite optimistic" the bill could pass in "the next few months" despite his non-consensus rebuke of the original Senate Banking draft in mid-January. Multiple crypto CEOs' tone more broadly seems to us to have become incrementally more positive than our initial due diligence suggested on the potential for legislative progress; however, we reiterate our view that the Senate is operating on a tight timeline, burdened by other legislative goals, recesses around the holidays, and 2026 midterm election campaigning. Note that new products announced at the December 2025 System Update (recap linked here) are "not materially dependent" on regulatory unlocks provided by laws.

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Key Changes (FYE Dec)

	Prev	Cur	Δ
Adj. EPS - 26E ($)	2.41	1.83	-24.2%
Adj. EPS - 27E ($)	3.71	4.35	17.3%

Quarterly Forecasts (FYE Dec)

Adj. EPS ($)

	2025A	2026E	2027E
Q1	1.93	0.39	1.00
Q2	0.12	0.42	1.11
Q3	1.44	0.38	1.07
Q4	0.66	0.63	1.17
FY	4.03	1.83	4.35

Style Exposure

Quant Factors	Current %Rank	Hist %Rank (1=Top) 6M	1Y	3Y	5Y
Value	92	41	94	100	
Growth	67	82	94	91	
Momentum	53	89	6	80	
Quality	18	15	17	41	99
Low Vol	97	100	100	100	

Sources for: Style Exposure – J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy; all other tables are company data and J.P. Morgan estimates.

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Price Performance

	YTD	1m	3m	12m
Abs	-37.6%	-41.9%	-53.6%	-48.7%
Rel	-37.4%	-39.9%	-53.3%	-61.6%

Company Data

Shares O/S (mn)	268
52-week range ($)	444.64-139.36
Market cap ($ mn)	37,849.79
Exchange rate	1.00
Free float (%)	97.0%
3M ADV (mn)	9.85
3M ADV ($ mn)	2,291.5
Volatility (90 Day)	67
Index	S&P 500
BBG ANR (Buy | Hold | Sell)	26|12|4

Key Metrics (FYE Dec)

in	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E
Financial Estimates			
ADV - Equities	-	-	-
ADV - Derivatives	-	-	-
Total revenue	7,181	5,988	7,460
Operating expense	-	-	-
Adj. EBITDA	2,808	1,979	3,057
Adj. EBIT	1,435	732	1,689
Adj. net income	1,156	487	1,208
Adj. EPS	4.03	1.83	4.35
BBG EPS	4.41	5.39	6.67
DPS	-	-	-
Margins and Growth			
Total revenue growth	9.4%	(16.6%)	24.6%
EBIT margin	20.0%	12.2%	22.6%
Net margin	16.1%	8.1%	16.2%
Adj. EPS growth	(46.9%)	(54.6%)	138.0%
Ratios			
Adj. tax rate	14.1%	25.0%	25.0%
Dividend payout	-	-	-
Net debt/Equity	NM	NM	NM
Net debt/EBITDA	NM	NM	NM
ROA	4.4%	1.6%	4.1%
ROE	9.2%	3.3%	8.2%
Valuation			
Dividend yield	-	-	-
Adj. P/E	35.1	77.2	32.4
P/ BV	2.7	2.5	2.6

Summary Investment Thesis and Valuation

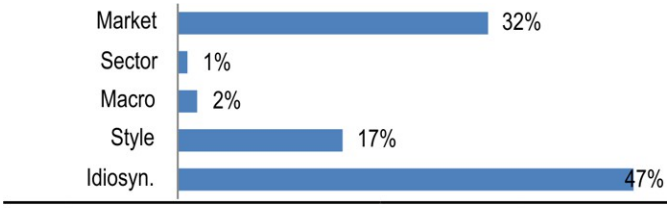
Investment Thesis

We have an Overweight rating on Coinbase. We see Coinbase as both a leading driver and beneficiary of the cryptocurrency economy, and we previously underestimated the strength of the U.S. spot ETPs and the 2024 U.S. general election as key catalysts for the crypto industry. We see the longer-term success of Coinbase being driven by development, with our focus on tokenization and payments.

Valuation

Our Dec 2026 price target of $252 is derived using a SOTP approach: 1) 40x multiple on our FY27E ex-Circle earnings estimate after which we add 2) Circle's current market cap, 3) Coinbase's crypto investments at a 10% discount, and 4) Coinbase's share of the potential Base token market cap.

Performance Drivers



Factors	6M Corr	1Y Corr
Market: MSCI US	0.56	0.57
Sect: Financials	0.05	-0.12
Ind: Diversified Fin	0.06	-0.10
Macro:		
Crude Oil	-0.07	-0.12
Non-Energy Commodity	0.15	0.11
US 10yr yield	0.17	-0.10
Quant Styles:		
LowVol	-0.49	-0.40
Size	-0.21	-0.21
Quality	-0.29	-0.14

Source: J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy for Performance Drivers; company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan estimates for all other tables. Note: Price history may not be complete or exact.

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- **Expense growth likely to decelerate in 2026, worse crypto environment.** Coinbase reported total FY25 GAAP operating expenses of $5,746mn, up 35% YoY. While Coinbase seems committed to investing in the business despite a crypto cycle downturn, mgmt guided to a deceleration in expense growth in 1Q26. Here, mgmt offered a 1Q26 expense outlook flat-to-down from 4Q25 actual expense levels including $925-975mn in technology and development and G&A expenses (4Q25 $950mn) alongside $215-315mn in sales and marketing expenses ($315mn). We now model $940mn and $223mn, respectively. Recall, COIN is committed to remaining adj. EBITDA positive through the cycle, so we expect mgmt to be nimble with expense management and flex costs lower if the top-line environment were to weaken further. We note that Coinbase continues to move USDC rewards payments around. But with the prioritization of CoinbaseOne, we see a meaningful decline in rewards payments in coming quarters and we thus remove ~$300mn from our USDC rewards payment projections in 2026.
- **Revenue outlook dims.** Regarding transaction revenue, mgmt offered some insight into how the business has been performing, with references to Coinbase customers as net buyers 2026TD even as the total crypto market has sold off 23% YTD. We see total Coinbase ADV tracking 12% lower 1Q26TD, with aggregate volumes totaling $98bn as of earlier this week (~6.8% spot market share vs. 6.4% in 4Q25). Coinbase shared it has recorded ~$420mn in transaction revenue as of February 10—we model $803mn in transaction revenue for the full quarter with lower sequential volumes and lower tax rates. Separately, in subscriptions and services revneue, mgmt guided to $550-630mn (midpoint -19% QoQ). We have already observed higher staking participation rates (i.e. lower yields), USDC market cap (-3% YTD), and lower token market caps weighing on growth here—we model $579mn in 1Q26 (-20% QoQ, -17% YoY).

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Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Coinbase *(Overweight; Price Target: $252.00)*

Investment Thesis

We have an Overweight rating on Coinbase. We see Coinbase as both a leading driver and beneficiary of the cryptocurrency economy, and we previously underestimated the strength of the U.S. spot Bitcoin ETPs in its early days—launched January 2024—as a key catalyst for the crypto industry. Spot ether ETPs soon followed. The 2024 U.S. general election and reset of expectations around the crypto operating and regulatory environment was a monumental catalyst as well. We see the longer-term success of Coinbase being driven by development, with our focus on Base, tokenization, and payments

Valuation

Our Dec 2026 price target of $252 is derived from a sum-of-the-parts approach: 1) JPMe FY27E Coinbase earnings ex-Circle's stablecoin revenue, 2) Circle's current valuation, 3) Coinbase's crypto investments on the balance sheet, and 4) now, its share of the potential Base token market cap. We arrive at $1.09bn of FY27E non-Circle earnings at Coinbase, and applying a 40x multiple gets us to a per share equity value of $161. In parallel, we add Circle's total market cap value of ~$13bn over the number of Coinbase shares, which is $57. We also add $7 representing the crypto investments on balance sheet discounted by 10% ($1.8bn), per share. Finally, we add $27 to represent Coinbase's share of the potential Base token market cap. Combined, we arrive at our price target of $252, which declined from the prior publication due to a decline in Cirlce's share price. Our 40x price target multiple mirrors where arguably less diversified crypto peers are currently trading, which we view as appropriate for Coinbase.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Risk to cryptocurrency markets. If the cryptocurrency markets decline meaningfully off this higher base that the market has rallied to since 4Q23, Coinbase may underperform. In other words, if the enthusiasm and activity currently supporting the ecosystem deflates, then crypto markets may decline and Coinbase may suffer.

Competition. We view global crypto spot trading as highly fragmented with dozens of smaller players threatening Coinbase's market share. We think this risk is especially relevant and pertinent now as we see more crypto exchanges threatening the regulated monopoly that Coinbase has enjoyed as the only publicly-traded crypto exchange over the last roughly four years as more exchanges come public. If Coinbase were to lose market share, the stock would underperform.

Outcome of U.S. crypto legislation. In the near term, the U.S. Congress is currently drafting market structure legislation for crypto market structure. While any sort of legislative or regulatory clarity is generally seen as a positive for Coinbase, if the final laws passed are somehow more restrictive and increase legal and bureaucratic costs for Coinbase's operating model, the impact of such legislation may be less net positive than originally anticipated.

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Coinbase: Summary of Financials

Income Statement - Annual	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Trading revenues	-	-	-	-
Net revenue	7,181	5,988	7,460	-
Compensation	-	-	-	-
Non-compensation expense	-	-	-	-
Operating income	1,435	732	1,689	-
EBITDA	2,808	1,979	3,057	-
Other income / (expense)	701	0	0	-
Pretax income	1,522	649	1,611	-
Income taxes	(262)	(162)	(403)	-
Net income - GAAP	1,277	487	1,208	-
Net income - recurring	1,156	487	1,208	-
Diluted shares outstanding	287	267	278	-
EPS - operating	4.03	1.83	4.35	-
EPS - GAAP	4.45	1.83	4.35	-

Income Statement - Quarterly	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E
Trading revenues	-	-	-	-
Total revenue	1,439	1,498	1,471	1,580
Compensation	-	-	-	-
Non-compensation expense	-	-	-	-
Operating income	161	168	156	248
EBITDA	464	482	466	567
Other income / (expense)	0	0	0	0
Pretax income	138	146	136	229
Income taxes	(35)	(37)	(34)	(57)
Net income - GAAP	104	110	102	171
Net income - recurring	104	110	102	171
Diluted shares outstanding	264	264	267	270
EPS - operating	0.39	0.42	0.38	0.63
EPS - GAAP	0.39	0.42	0.38	0.63

Balance Sheet and Cash Flow Data	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Cash and cash equivalents	11,285	11,285	11,285	-
Current assets	20,388	20,388	20,388	-
Total assets	29,672	29,672	29,672	-
Total debt	7,659	7,659	7,659	-
Total liabilities	14,879	14,879	14,879	-
Preferred stockholders' equity	-	-	-	-
Common stockholders' equity	14,793	14,793	14,793	-
Net income	-	-	-	-
D&A	-	-	-	-
Capex	-	-	-	-
Adj. Free cash flow to firm	73	62	59	-
FCF / share	0.26	0.23	0.21	-

Ratio Analysis	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue growth	9.4%	(16.6%)	24.6%	-
EPS growth	(46.9%)	(54.6%)	138.0%	-
Gross margin	-	-	-	-
EBITDA margin	39.1%	33.1%	41.0%	-
Tax rate	17.2%	25.0%	25.0%	-
Net income margin	16.1%	8.1%	16.2%	-
Return on equity (ROE)	9.2%	3.3%	8.2%	-
Dividends	-	-	-	-
Dividend payout ratio	-	-	-	-
Consolidated volumes (ADV)	-	-	-	-
Volume growth (YoY)	-	-	-	-

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.
Note: $ in millions (except per-share data).Fiscal year ends Dec

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Coinbase (COIN, COIN US) Price Chart

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage May 25, 2021. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price ($)	Price Target ($)
17-Feb-23	N	65.59	52
21-Feb-23	N	65.20	57
26-Apr-23	N	55.55	55
05-May-23	N	49.22	59
02-Aug-23	N	94.15	61
04-Aug-23	N	90.75	64
24-Oct-23	N	77.21	74
02-Nov-23	N	77.81	80
22-Jan-24	UW	124.75	80
16-Feb-24	N	160.38	95
15-Mar-24	N	233.67	150
03-May-24	N	228.85	171
29-Jul-24	N	242.93	181
28-Oct-24	N	205.04	196
07-Feb-25	N	270.37	264
14-Feb-25	N	298.11	344
02-May-25	N	201.30	276
09-May-25	N	206.50	215
25-Jul-25	N	396.70	404
31-Jul-25	N	377.48	342
24-Oct-25	OW	322.76	404
31-Oct-25	OW	328.51	399
09-Feb-26	OW	165.12	290

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IB clients**	47%	47%	35%
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IB clients**	72%	70%	53%

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